■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, July 10, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (2 stories)

■ *Gordie Howe Bridge finally opens—what took so long?*

The Angle: *After years of delays and billions in investment, Canada and Michigan are officially opening the Gordie Howe International Bridge on July 27. This is a major infrastructure win for cross-border trade and commuters between Windsor and Detroit—but it's also a symbol of how long mega-projects actually take to finish.*

- **Canada and Michigan** agreed to open the **Gordie Howe International Bridge on July 27**
- The bridge connects **Windsor, Ontario and Detroit, Michigan**
- It's designed to ease **cross-border trade and traffic congestion** on existing routes

The Commute Question

- For anyone who's sat in traffic crossing the Canada-US border—are you actually going to use this thing, or is it too late to break your commute habits?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.4236164?cmp=rss

■ *SoCal Dog trainer learns fate for trapping and killing 11 dogs*

The Angle: *SoCal Dog trainer learns fate for trapping and killing 11 dogs*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/10/us-news/socal-dog-trainer-learns-fate-for-trapping-animals-in-small-cages-leaving-them-to-die/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *George Lucas' billion-dollar museum opens its doors free to neighbors*

The Angle: *A major new cultural institution in L.A. is making a deliberate play to serve the low-income community around it—offering free annual passes and early access to residents before the public even arrives. It's a rare move that's sparking conversation about who museums are really built for.*

- **Lucas Museum of Narrative Art** opens to the public **Sept. 22** in a low-income Los Angeles neighborhood
- The institution is a **billion-dollar** cultural space built by **George Lucas**
- **A quarter of the population** in the surrounding neighborhood lives below the poverty line
- The museum is offering **free annual passes** and **early preview access** to closest residential neighbors before the public launch

The Big Gesture Question

- Is this genuine community investment, or a billionaire's PR play—and does the motive actually matter if neighbors get free access to a world-class museum?

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/news/local-news/george-lucas-museum-free-access-neighbors-1236643651/

Backup options:

■ *Hollywood's LGBTQ character count drops for third straight year*

The Angle: *A new GLAAD report shows LGBTQ representation in major studio films is shrinking, not growing — and it's sparking questions about whether the industry's diversity promises were ever real.*

- **GLAAD** found **zero LGBTQ characters** in **19 animated/family films** from the 10 biggest studio distributors
- **No transgender characters** appeared in the entire crop of **225 films** studied
- **LGBTQ character count has dropped for three consecutive years** according to the latest report

The Industry Call-Out

- Are studios deliberately backtracking on representation, or is Hollywood's diversity talk just empty PR—and does it actually matter to viewers?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - 30 seconds -> Co-host reads the stark numbers aloud—zero LGBTQ, zero trans characters in 225 films—and lets that land with the audience
- **Step 2: The Question** - 1 minute -> Ask listeners: Is this a coincidence or a choice? Have you *noticed* fewer LGBTQ characters at the movies lately, or are the studios just hiding them?
- **Step 3: The Deeper Take** - 2 minutes -> Debate whether Hollywood made loud diversity promises that were never backed by real change—or if there's a business/market reason studios are pulling back now

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/glaad-study-lgbtq-characters-film-1236642072/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

(no candidate scored high enough today)

CLOSER: WHAT THE FRIDAY

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *'The Hunger Games' Movies Return to Theaters for 'Sunrise on Reaping' - Variety*

The Angle: *'The Hunger Games' Movies Return to Theaters for 'Sunrise on Reaping' - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/hunger-games-films-return-theaters-sunrise-on-reaping-1236805982/

■ *Cute or cringe? The internet weighs in on Trudeau's TikTok 'dancing debut'*

The Angle: *Cute or cringe? The internet weighs in on Trudeau's TikTok 'dancing debut'*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/justin-trudeau-katy-perry-watch-it-burn-clip-9.7266505?cmp=rss

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■ *Gordie Howe International Bridge to open July 27, Ottawa confirms*

The Angle: *Gordie Howe International Bridge to open July 27, Ottawa confirms*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/windsor/gordie-howe-bridge-opening-9.7266280?cmp=rss

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■ *Cuba's power grid collapses again—second blackout in a week*

The Angle: *Cuba is facing its fourth nationwide blackout of the year as an aging electrical system and a U.S. oil embargo create a perfect storm. This isn't just a local power issue—it's a humanitarian crisis playing out in real time on an island of 11 million people.*

- **Second massive blackout in one week**—Cuba's entire electrical grid collapsed on Friday, following another nationwide outage just days earlier
- **Fourth grid failure this year**, signaling a systemic collapse rather than isolated incidents
- The crisis is driven by a combination of **U.S.-imposed oil blockade** and **obsolete generation infrastructure** that can't handle demand
- The island nation is struggling to keep basic services running—hospitals, water systems, and transportation all depend on power the grid can no longer reliably provide

The Reality Check

- How long can a country actually function without reliable electricity—and what does this tell us about how fragile modern infrastructure really is?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/cuba-electrical-grid-second-failure-9.7266810?cmp=rss

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■ *2nd boat was with B.C. charter before fatal sinking, raising rescue questions*

The Angle: *2nd boat was with B.C. charter before fatal sinking, raising rescue questions*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/2nd-boat-bc-charter-fatal-sinking-near-richmond-9.7266178?cmp=rss

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■ *Pipeline plans spark Indigenous leadership fury across Canada*

The Angle: *First Nations chiefs say the government blindsided them on major energy infrastructure projects that directly affect their lands—raising fresh questions about whether Ottawa's consultation promises are real or just theater.*

- **Two pipelines** announced in **Alberta, B.C., and Ontario** with **First Nations chiefs** learning about plans through **last-minute emails and rumours** rather than formal government outreach
- Indigenous leaders say they were **not meaningfully engaged** before public announcements were made
- The controversy centres on whether **government consultation obligations** to First Nations are being met on major infrastructure projects

The Trust Buster

- Is this a broken promise or a breakdown in communication—and which side do you think is actually at fault here?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/indigenous/ontario-alberta-bc-chiefs-pipelines-reaction-9.7266055?cmp=rss

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■ *Ottawa councillors blast unannounced, belated Canada Day fireworks show*

The Angle: *Ottawa councillors blast unannounced, belated Canada Day fireworks show*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ottawa/ottawa-fireworks-bluesfest-july-9-canada-day-reason-9.7265431?cmp=rss

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■ *Bats can catch and eat birds mid-flight. A painter may have known that 400 years before scientists*

The Angle: *Bats can catch and eat birds mid-flight. A painter may have known that 400 years before scientists*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/asithappens/bats-birds-brueghel-painting-9.7264580?cmp=rss

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■ *Meta's billion-dollar Alberta data centre faces power crunch*

The Angle: *Meta is betting **$13 billion** on a massive data centre near Edmonton that'll be ready in 2-3 years—but the natural gas power plant built specifically to feed it won't be online for at least four years. It's a classic tech infrastructure race against the clock, and someone's going to be scrambling.*

- **Meta's data centre costs $13 billion-plus** and is expected to operate within **two to three years**
- A new **natural gas-fired power plant** north of Edmonton won't be ready for **at least four years**
- The power plant is being built specifically to **serve the data centre's massive energy needs**
- The timing mismatch means Meta will need **interim power solutions** or face delays to its AI/cloud infrastructure rollout in Canada

The Planning Disaster

- When a $13-billion tech project launches before its power supply is ready, who takes the hit—and what's the backup plan?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/meta-data-centre-alberta-greenlight-power-plant-9.7266096?cmp=rss

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■ *Scottie Scheffler misses first cut in four years as Rory McIlroy leads at Scottish Open*

The Angle: *Scottie Scheffler misses first cut in four years as Rory McIlroy leads at Scottish Open*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/golf/scheffler-misses-cut-mcilroy-leads-scottish-open

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■ *SNOBELEN: Canada’s trucking industry rolling into a dangerous era*

The Angle: *SNOBELEN: Canada’s trucking industry rolling into a dangerous era*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/snobelen-canadas-trucking-industry-rolling-into-a-dangerous-era

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■ *Mets can’t get out of their own way again with loss — even after Red Sox’s brutal travel woes*

The Angle: *Mets can’t get out of their own way again with loss — even after Red Sox’s brutal travel woes*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/10/sports/mets-cant-get-out-of-their-own-way-again-with-loss-to-red-sox/

■ *Mamdani’s anti-Italian hate is no surprise — it is foundational to his Marxist beliefs*

The Angle: *Mamdani’s anti-Italian hate is no surprise — it is foundational to his Marxist beliefs*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/10/business/mamdanis-anti-italian-hate-makes-it-no-surprise-to-see-little-italy-wiped-off-the-nyc-immigrant-map/

■ *Eric Swalwell spent years coming for Trump — then tried silencing critics*

The Angle: *Eric Swalwell spent years coming for Trump — then tried silencing critics*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/10/opinion/eric-swalwells-accountability-problem/

■ *Anders Lee adjusting to 'big change' with Mammoth after long Islanders career: 'No doubt about it'*

The Angle: *Anders Lee adjusting to 'big change' with Mammoth after long Islanders career: 'No doubt about it'*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/10/sports/anders-lee-adjusting-to-big-change-with-mammoth-after-long-islanders-career/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Last American on iron lung for polio dies at 78*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Last living American polio iron lung patient death is a historically significant public health story with natural obituary momentum and vaccine debate resonance.

The Angle: *Martha Lillard was the final living symbol of polio's grip on America—she spent over seven decades in an iron lung after contracting the virus as a child. Her death marks the end of an era and a stark reminder of why vaccination matters, especially as polio resurfaces globally.*

- **Martha Lillard** was the **last known U.S. patient still using an iron lung** for polio
- She **died at age 78** in **Oklahoma**
- Lillard had been dependent on the iron lung for **more than 70 years** after contracting polio as a child
- Polio, once a scourge that paralyzed thousands of Americans annually, has resurged in parts of the world where vaccination rates have dropped

The History Check

- How many of you even knew what an iron lung was before today—or that polio was still a threat anywhere on Earth?

X/Twitter @CTVNews (Tier 1) | Score: 52/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/CTVNews/status/2075754619104346349

■ *Sony Music to Close Punk Merch Warehouse That Just Voted to Unionize https://t.co/12hlKgOeuR*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Labor union retaliation closure is a clear David-vs-Goliath narrative hitting peak unionization discourse moment with corporate villain angle.

The Angle: *Sony Music to Close Punk Merch Warehouse That Just Voted to Unionize https://t.co/12hlKgOeuR*

X/Twitter @Gizmodo (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Gizmodo/status/2075693822260936841

■ *Anthony Hopkins Just Became a Classical Composer—Seriously*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Oscar winner Anthony Hopkins pivoting to classical composition is a genuine celebrity reinvention story with built-in prestige angle and crossover appeal.

The Angle: *The Oscar winner and Hollywood legend is pivoting to classical music with a major record deal. It's the kind of unexpected celebrity move that has people asking: is he actually talented at this, or is this just famous-person vanity?*

- **Anthony Hopkins**, Oscar-winning actor, signed with **Decca Classics** as a classical composer
- Hopkins has composed music for years but this is his first major record label deal in the classical space
- The partnership positions Hopkins alongside serious classical artists on one of the world's most prestigious classical music labels

The Plot Twist

- Do you buy it—is this a genuine artistic pivot or just another celebrity side hustle playing with expensive toys?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Credential Check** - Opening segment -> Host A plays a clip of Hopkins talking about his compositional background; Host B does a quick riff on whether this is 'real' or vanity—tie it to other actors who play musicians or vice versa
- **Step 2: The Phone Question** - Mid-segment -> Ask callers: Have you ever discovered a hidden talent in someone famous that totally surprised you? Or is celebrity classical music always a hard pass?
- **Step 3: The Take** - Tag-out -> Compare to other actors-turned-musicians (Jeff Bridges, Cher, etc.)—does the prestige of *Decca Classics* make this feel different, or does it still feel like a playground for the rich and famous?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Billboard/status/2075676470408581362

■ *Meta pulls the plug on new AI image tool after swift backlash*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Meta suspending AI image feature after days of backlash shows momentum on AI safety concerns and corporate retreat - early signs of a growing story.

The Angle: *Meta launched an AI image-generation feature and killed it within days—a rare corporate U-turn that signals how fast the public can force tech giants to retreat when something rubs people the wrong way. It's a window into the ongoing tension between AI innovation and real-world pushback.*

- **Meta** suspended its AI image feature after **days of backlash** from users and critics
- The tool generated images from user prompts using the company's AI models
- The quick reversal highlights growing public pressure on tech companies over AI safety and misuse concerns

The Speed Test

- How many days should it take a tech giant to kill a feature—and does a quick pullback mean they were actually listening, or just damage-controlling?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Timeline** - First 60 seconds -> Host A: 'Walk me through this—when did Meta launch it?' Host B: 'Days ago.' Host A: 'And now it's gone.' Quick recap of the speed.
- **Step 2: The Backlash Breakdown** - Next 90 seconds -> Hosts dig into what specifically people were mad about—deepfakes? Misinformation? Copyright? Get specific on the complaint.
- **Step 3: The Corporate Pattern** - Final 60 seconds -> Host: 'Is this a win for public accountability, or is Meta just getting better at damage control?' Flip sides—which narrative sticks?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2075719159917293841

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 1 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 9 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After ‘Bottle Rocket’ Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "‘Rent’ West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)

- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro ‘Miró’ Sneakers: Here’s Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of ‘Pokémon Go’ Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by bringing out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by brining out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.co" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-10)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Thousands of ‘Pokémon Go’ Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by bringing out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.c"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Jay-Z opens his ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th anniversary show at Yankee Stadium by brining out Beyoncé for “Can’t Knock the Hustle.” https://t.co"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 14 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-10 11:43 PM